



THE AUSSIES HAVE BEEN CRUSHED, BUT HAVE NOT BEEN **CRUSHED CONCLUSIVELY.** THAT RESULT IS STILL TWO WEEKS AWAY.

quite obviously is shifting. Much may have gone according to plan for one team but little in the series has gone according to type.

Before a ball was bowled, it was Virender Sehwag, rather than any arriving Aussie, who forecast the result: "Either 3-1 or 3-0 to India." Bangalore Man of the Match Zaheer Khan heckled the Aussies for not scoring quickly and being unable to take 20 wickets. In Mohali, Dhoni asked first slip Rahul Dravid to check out the scoreboard: Australia 22 off 13 overs. At that moment, an on-field landing of Martians in a flying saucer would have caused less shock. In their four innings in India, Australia have scored their runs at 2.86, 3.12, 2.63 and 3.10 per over, this when their batting is the stronger and more experienced component of their team.

Usually meticulous planners, Australia appear surprised that the Indian SG Test ball acts differently from their familiar Kookaburra and does not do as they want it to, but turns into a

PERFECT PLOT:
Indian players
celebrate an
Aussie wicket in
Mohali

AFP PHOTO



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